



- Rub out all mistakes completely.
- Print your details clearly in the boxes provided.
- Make sure you fill in only one oval in each column.

FIRST NAME

D	E	B	B	I	E
A	A	A	A	A	A
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E	E	E	E	E	E

LAST NAME

B	A	C	H
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B	B	B	B
C	C	C	C
D	D	D	D
E	E	E	E

FIRST NAME **LAST NAME**

C	H	A	N
A	A	A	A
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E	E	E	E

A	I	B	E	N	G
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FIRST NAME

J	A	M	A	L			B	I	N
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LAST NAME

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			D
			E

[illegible][illegible]

☐ Male ☐ Female



☐ Yes ☐ No

Town / suburb: _____

Today's date: / / Postcode:

Day	Month	Year
0	0	0
1	1	1
2	2	2
3	3	3
4	4	4
5	5	5
6	6	6
7	7	7
8	8	8
9	9	9

(A)	(K)
(B)	(L)
(C)	(M)
(D)	(N)
(E)	(O)
(F)	(P)
(G)	(Q)
(H)	(R)
(I)	(S)
(J)	(T)

TO ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

Example:

Choose the option that best completes the sentence.

You should take an umbrella _____ it might rain.

- (A) although
- (B) because
- (C) when
- (D) if

The answer is because, so fill in the oval (B), as shown.

(A) (B) (C) (D)



START

1 (A) (B) (C) (D)

2 (A) (B) (C) (D)

3 (A) (B) (C) (D)

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45 (A) (B) (C) (D)





E

2012 English Answer Keys

ICAS
International Competitions
and Assessments for Schools

Question Number	Paper A	Paper B	Paper C	Paper D	Paper E	Paper F	Papers G & H	Papers I & J
1	D	A	B	A	B	A	D	A
2	B	B	D	A	D	D	C	C
3	A	A	D	C	D	C	A	B
4	B	C	B	C	D	B	C	B
5	A	D	B	A	C	D	C	C
6	C	A	C	B	B	B	B	A
7	A	A	B	A	C	D	D	D
8	B	D	D	A	A	C	A	A
9	D	A	B	D	B	D	D	D
10	C	A	A	B	A	A	D	D
11	A	D	C	C	A	C	A	A
12	B	A	A	A	C	B	C	C
13	A	B	C	D	D	A	D	D
14	D	A	A	B	B	C	A	C
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18	D	B	C	C	D	D	B	A
19	C	C	A	B	A	B	B	B
20	D	D	D	C	A	C	D	B
21	B	D	B	A	C	B	B	B
22	A	A	C	D	B	B	A	A
23	C	D	D	B	C	C	B	A
24	A	C	C	B	B	D	B	D
25	D	B	B	A	B	A	C	D
26	A	A	C	D	C	B	A	B
27	A	C	B	B	D	A	A	B
28	D	C	A	A	A	B	D	C
29	A	B	B	B	C	B	A	D
30	B	C	D	D	A	C	B	C

(Please turn over)



E | 2012 English Answer Keys

ICAS
International Competitions
and Assessments for Schools

Question Number	Paper A	Paper B	Paper C	Paper D	Paper E	Paper F	Papers G & H	Papers I & J
31	A	B	D	C	C	A	D	A
32	C	B	C	A	D	A	D	D
33	B	D	C	D	B	D	D	A
34	C	B	C	B	B	A	D	C
35	D	A	D	B	C	B	A	D
36	C	C	A	C	C	C	C	D
37	C	A	C	D	B	D	B	A
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39	B	B	B	D	B	A	C	C
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46			D	D	D	D	C	B
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53					C	A	B	A
54					B	D	C	C
55					A	C	B	B
56							D	C
57							B	B
58							A	C
59							A	A
60							B	B

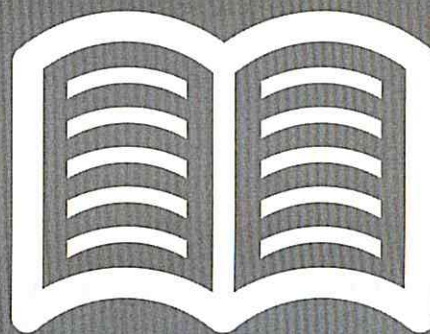
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**PAPER
B**



2012
ICAS

International Competitions
and Assessments for Schools

ENGLISH

**Educational
Assessment
Australia**
eaa.unsw.edu.au

DO NOT OPEN THIS BOOKLET UNTIL INSTRUCTED.

45 QUESTIONS

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

STUDENT'S NAME:

Read the instructions on the **ANSWER SHEET** and fill in your **NAME, SCHOOL** and **OTHER INFORMATION**.
Use a 2B or B pencil.
Do **NOT** use a pen.
Rub out any mistakes completely.

You **MUST** record your answers on the **ANSWER SHEET**.

Mark only **ONE** answer for each question.
Your score will be the number of correct answers.
Marks are **NOT** deducted for incorrect answers.

There are **45 MULTIPLE-CHOICE QUESTIONS** (1–45).
Use the information provided to choose the **BEST** answer from the four possible options.
On your **ANSWER SHEET** fill in the oval that matches your answer.

Questions may sometimes be placed next to each other.
Make sure you read **ACROSS** the page and answer the questions in the correct order.

You are **NOT** allowed to use a dictionary or an electronic translator.

Counting on Frank

My Dad says, 'If you've got a brain, then use it!' So I do.

I sit down and fill my notebook with facts. Did you know that the average ballpoint pen draws a line two thousand and sixty metres long, before the ink runs out? My parents consider this fact to be a bit childish, but I'm sure the pen company would like to know.

My dog, Frank, is pretty big and takes up a lot of space. I calculate that twenty-four Franks could fit into my bedroom, but sometimes there isn't even room for one.

If Frank were a humpback whale, however, then only ten would fit into our entire house. I asked Dad about this and he said they would get in the way of the television.

The local club had a competition. You had to guess how many jelly beans were in the jar, and the prize was a trip to Hawaii.

They didn't know who they were dealing with.

There are seven hundred and forty-five jelly beans in the average lolly jar—I thought everybody knew that!

As Dad said on the plane to Hawaii, 'If you've got a brain, then use it.'



1. 'My Dad says, "If you've got a brain, then use it!" So I do.'
This means that the narrator followed his father's
(A) advice.
(B) warning.
(C) promise.
(D) argument.
2. What did the narrator fill his notebook with?
(A) lines
(B) facts
(C) pictures of Frank
(D) competition entries
3. 'They didn't know who they were dealing with.'
In this sentence, 'They' refers to people
(A) at the local club.
(B) at the pen company.
(C) who make jelly beans.
(D) on the plane to Hawaii.
4. Which quotation from the story shows that the narrator thought the answer to the competition was obvious?
(A) 'You had to guess how many jelly beans were in the jar'
(B) 'There are seven hundred and forty-five jelly beans in the average lolly jar'
(C) 'I thought everybody knew that!'
(D) "'If you've got a brain, then use it.'"
5. Which words best describe the narrator?
(A) shy and reserved
(B) rude and arrogant
(C) friendly and curious
(D) focussed and confident
6. What does the illustration tell us about Frank?
(A) He is treated as a member of the family.
(B) The narrator likes to copy what he does.
(C) The narrator and his father are afraid of him.
(D) He is spoilt and complains until he gets his way.
7. The word 'Counting' is used in the title of the story because
(A) the narrator is interested in numbers.
(B) it is difficult to be accurate with numbers.
(C) being good at numbers is needed to win a prize.
(D) Frank depends on the narrator to help him with numbers.

BUG buffet



Today's lunch will be fried grasshoppers, fresh fly larvae and spiced cockroaches, with honeyed locusts for dessert. It might sound disgusting, but it's a healthy meal.

You may not be ready to tuck into a big plate of crispy grasshoppers, but in many cultures eating insects is part of a normal diet—some insects are even a delicacy! People in Africa, Asia and Australia have eaten insects as part of their diet for thousands of years.

There are currently 1462 recorded species of edible insects, including ants, dragonflies, grasshoppers, termites and fly larvae. But why would anyone eat insects?

Insects are a good source of protein, and many contain minerals such as calcium, iron and zinc. Eating 100 grams of cooked caterpillar can provide more than your daily requirement of iron, copper, zinc and thiamin. Almost all insects have more iron than beef and fish, while dung beetles and termites have quite a high level of protein. Many insects are also lower in fat than beef, lamb, pork or chicken.

So what is the yummiest way to eat insects? Well, it depends on what you like. Insects can be fried, boiled, roasted, barbequed, stir-fried, ground up or freeze-dried. If you have a sweet tooth, you can get your insects in a lollipop.

Many insects are eaten as larvae but ants, grasshoppers and crickets are almost always eaten as adults. Grasshoppers are the most widely eaten insect and can be eaten salted or ground up and baked into a cake.

'Yuck, I'd never eat bugs,' I hear you say. Well, you may not know it, but you will probably eat half a kilogram of bugs in your lifetime or maybe even more. Insect body parts contaminate many everyday foods found in your kitchen. Dried foods such as flour and oats often contain insect eggs and if left at room temperature for long enough, these eggs will eventually hatch into larvae. Even chocolate can contain insect body parts!

Before you go out and start collecting bugs for your own buffet, there are a few rules you should know. First, brightly coloured insects such as some caterpillars should be avoided as they are likely to be poisonous. Second, insects that contain poison, such as wasps, must be boiled so the stinger and poison don't make you sick. Third, any insects sprayed with garden poisons and insecticides should not be eaten.

Finally, don't forget: if you decide to tuck into some tasty fly larvae, make sure that you share them with your friends.

Nutritional values

	Nutritional value per 100 grams	
	Protein (grams)	Iron (milligrams)
Dung beetle	17.2	7.7
Cricket	12.9	9.5
Grasshopper	14.3	3.0
Caterpillar	6.7	13.1
Termite	14.2	35.5
Weevil	6.7	13.1
Beef	27.4	3.5
Fish	28.5	1.0

8. The writer describes some insects as a 'delicacy'. This means that they are
- (A) very fragile.
 - (B) difficult to cook.
 - (C) commonly eaten.
 - (D) especially prized.
9. 'There are currently 1462 recorded species of edible insects, including ants, dragonflies, grasshoppers, termites and fly larvae.'
- Which option suggests that more species will probably be added to that list?
- (A) 'currently' (B) '1462' (C) 'edible' (D) 'including'
10. What feature of the table best highlights the nutritional value of insects compared with beef and fish?
- (A) the use of shading
 - (B) the list of different insects
 - (C) the even width of the columns
 - (D) the use of grams and milligrams
11. According to the table, which of the following statements is correct?
- (A) Beef contains more protein than fish.
 - (B) Fish contains more iron than caterpillars.
 - (C) Caterpillars contain more iron than weevils.
 - (D) Dung beetles contain more protein than termites.
12. Why does the writer say that 'you will probably eat half a kilogram of bugs in your lifetime'?
- (A) It is common for people to eat insects without knowing it.
 - (B) This is the quantity of insects that people require in their diet.
 - (C) Most people will eventually decide to try eating some insects.
 - (D) Being eaten by humans is part of the life cycle of some insects.
13. According to the text, which of the following statements about eating insects is correct?
- (A) All insects can be eaten if they are properly prepared.
 - (B) The grasshopper is the most popular insect eaten.
 - (C) All flying insects are made safe by boiling them.
 - (D) Only adult insects are eaten by people.
14. The tone of the final sentence is
- (A) humorous. (B) sarcastic. (C) demanding. (D) enthusiastic.
15. Throughout the text what does the writer assume about her readers?
- (A) They would like to experiment with eating insects.
 - (B) They have probably tried eating insects in the past.
 - (C) They would naturally dislike the idea of eating insects.
 - (D) They are looking for new ways to prepare insects to eat.

For questions 16 to 18 read *The fox and the grapes* and choose the best word to complete the passage.

The fox and the grapes

One hot summer's day a fox was strolling through an orchard when he saw a bunch of grapes just ripening on a vine which was growing along a lofty branch. 'Just the thing to _____ (16) _____ my thirst,' he said. Drawing back a few paces, he took a run and a jump and just missed the bunch. Turning around again with a 'One, two, three', he jumped up but with no greater _____ (17) _____. Again and again he tried to reach the _____ (18) _____ fruit. Finally he walked away with his nose in the air, saying, 'I am sure they are sour.'

It is easy to despise what you cannot get.

16. (A) finish
(B) delay
(C) quench
(D) prevent

17. (A) effort
(B) success
(C) distance
(D) increase

18. (A) hidden
(B) tempting
(C) rewarding
(D) expensive

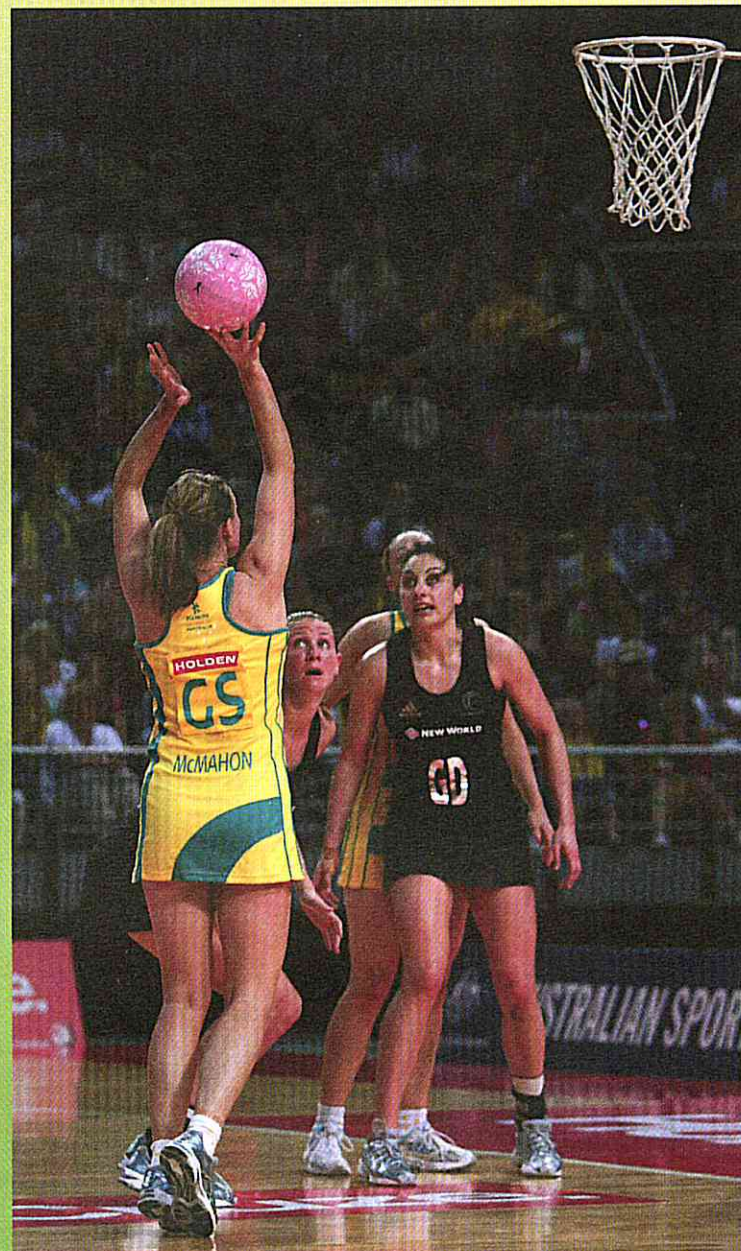


For questions 19 and 20 read *Netball* and choose the correct option to complete the passage.

Netball

The popular game now known as netball originated in England in the late 1800s. ____ (19) ____ it came to Australia and New Zealand around 1900, it was known as women's basketball, but the name was changed to netball in 1970. Every country that played the game had its own rules until 1957, when an international conference established a set of common rules. A governing body for the sport was formed in 1960 and world championships ____ (20) ____ every four years since 1963.

19. (A) Then
(B) Since
(C) When
(D) While
20. (A) were held
(B) has been held
(C) had been held
(D) have been held



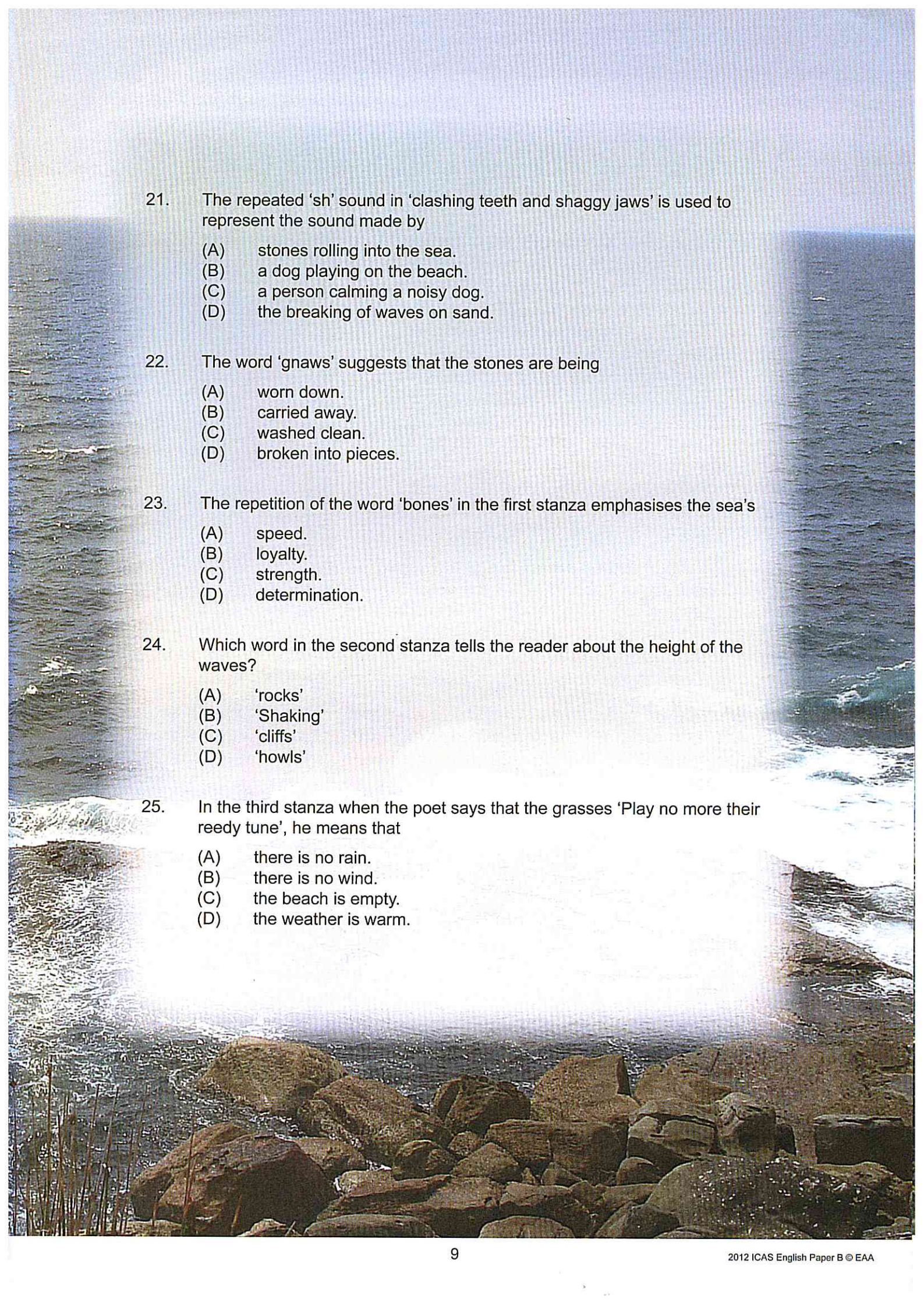
The Sea

The sea is a hungry dog,
Giant and grey.
He rolls on the beach all day.
With his clashing teeth and shaggy jaws
Hour upon hour he gnaws
The rumbling, tumbling stones,
And 'Bones, bones, bones, bones!'
The giant sea-dog moans,
Licking his greasy paws.

And when the night wind roars
And the moon rocks in the stormy cloud,
He bounds to his feet and snuffs and sniffs,
Shaking his wet sides over the cliffs,
And howls and hollos long and loud.

But on quiet days in May or June,
When even the grasses on the dune
Play no more their reedy tune,
With his head between his paws
He lies on the sandy shores,
So quiet, so quiet, he scarcely snores.

James Reeves

- 
21. The repeated 'sh' sound in 'clashing teeth and shaggy jaws' is used to represent the sound made by
- (A) stones rolling into the sea.
 - (B) a dog playing on the beach.
 - (C) a person calming a noisy dog.
 - (D) the breaking of waves on sand.
22. The word 'gnaws' suggests that the stones are being
- (A) worn down.
 - (B) carried away.
 - (C) washed clean.
 - (D) broken into pieces.
23. The repetition of the word 'bones' in the first stanza emphasises the sea's
- (A) speed.
 - (B) loyalty.
 - (C) strength.
 - (D) determination.
24. Which word in the second stanza tells the reader about the height of the waves?
- (A) 'rocks'
 - (B) 'Shaking'
 - (C) 'cliffs'
 - (D) 'howls'
25. In the third stanza when the poet says that the grasses 'Play no more their reedy tune', he means that
- (A) there is no rain.
 - (B) there is no wind.
 - (C) the beach is empty.
 - (D) the weather is warm.

Wolfgang Mozart

Can you imagine being a performer from the age of seven, away from home for years at a time, with no time for school, friends or games? This was the extraordinary childhood experience of Wolfgang Mozart (1756–1791), famous composer and child prodigy. He was called a child prodigy because even as a young child, he exhibited musical skills far beyond his age. He was a gifted performer and composer, playing the *clavier** at the age of four and composing short pieces of music when he was five. His older sister, nicknamed Nannerl, was also a talented musician but has been overshadowed in history by her more famous brother Wolfgang, known simply as Mozart.



Mozart and Nannerl had no experience of a carefree childhood. Their father Leopold neglected his own career and devoted his days to teaching his children and nurturing their talents. Music was their life. Leopold considered he had a duty to show off their astonishing musical gifts, and of course their performances made an important contribution to the family's income.

The children's extreme youth and talent were what made them remarkable as performers, so their father was determined to exploit the situation. When Mozart was six and Nannerl ten, the two prodigies started performing in royal courts across Europe. In 1763, when Mozart was eight, the whole family set out from their home in Salzburg on an extended tour of Europe. During the three years they were away from home, the children played in royal courts, in public and in churches. Leopold reported to a friend: 'We are being talked of everywhere. Everyone is amazed, especially at the boy, and everyone whom I have heard says that his genius is incomprehensible.'

Travelling in Mozart's time was very different to travelling today. Progress in their unheated horse-drawn carriage on badly maintained roads was slow, and the family had to wait for letters of invitation (no phones or emails then) before they could organise their schedule. They had to arrange their own lodgings, and rely on the generosity of their patrons for money. The children often performed twice a day, an exhausting schedule when they were so young. At various times all the members of the family fell dangerously ill.

Despite what we might consider a demanding childhood, Mozart seemed to delight in the attention he received. It was the only life he knew, and the music he composed in his relatively short life is still beloved around the world.

* an early keyboard instrument

26. Which word from the text is **OPPOSITE** in meaning to *concealed*?

- (A) 'exhibited'
- (B) 'overshadowed'
- (C) 'neglected'
- (D) 'devoted'

27. Which underlined word, as it is used in the third paragraph, is correctly matched to its part of speech?

	Word	Part of speech
(A)	'extreme'	adverb
(B)	'royal'	noun
(C)	'During'	preposition
(D)	'everyone'	adjective

28. 'In 1763, when Mozart was eight, the whole family set out from their home in Salzburg on an extended tour of Europe.'

Which part of this sentence is the main clause?

- (A) 'In 1793'
- (B) 'when Mozart was eight'
- (C) 'the whole family set out from their home in Salzburg'
- (D) 'on an extended tour of Europe'

29. Which quotation from the fourth paragraph shows how different things were in Mozart's time compared with today?

- (A) 'badly maintained roads'
- (B) 'no phones or emails'
- (C) 'arrange their own lodgings'
- (D) 'an exhausting schedule'

30. Mozart is famous because

- (A) he had a very difficult childhood.
- (B) he held many public performances.
- (C) the music he composed is still popular.
- (D) his father gave up his own career for him.

31. The main purpose of this text is

- (A) to examine the effects of fame on children.
- (B) to inform the reader about Mozart's early life.
- (C) to describe what life was like in the late 1700s.
- (D) to discuss how Mozart's father controlled Mozart's life.

The Trojan Horse

Sinon hid in the shadows of the towering walls that protected the city of Troy. As he waited, he nervously rehearsed his lines. The success of the whole plan rested on his ability to convince the Trojans that their Greek enemy had finally abandoned their siege of Troy and set sail for Greece.

He looked at the huge wooden horse that the wily Greeks had built and positioned outside the gates of the city. He wondered how his fellow soldiers were faring inside its vast stomach. They must be so hot and uncomfortable!

Finally some curious Trojans spied the enormous horse and came to investigate. For the first time in ten years the bustling Greek camp outside the city walls lay empty and silent. Were they really free at last? And what was the meaning of this huge horse? Sinon took a deep breath, stepped from his hiding place and began his extraordinary story.

'Have mercy on me!' he begged. 'My Greek brothers left me behind when they set sail for our homeland. They have finally realised that they will never take Troy. They built this horse as an acknowledgment of the might of Troy and left it as a tribute to your invincible strength.'

The Trojans were weary of war and flattered by Sinon's extravagant praise. Wanting to believe that the Greeks had finally left Troy, they decided to bring the horse into the city as a symbol of their victory.

Some people in the city were troubled by the monstrous creature and did not want it within the city walls, but their voices were lost in the confusion of the celebrations. Strong ropes were attached to the horse and excited citizens jostled each other to place their hand on a piece of rope and have the honour of pulling the Trojan horse through the city gates.

And so the Trojans themselves pulled the Greeks into their city. That night the soldiers crept out of the horse, opened the gates and admitted the army that was hidden outside. The Greeks defeated Troy and the rest is history. The term 'Trojan Horse' has now become a metaphor for any offer that looks beguiling but ultimately brings disaster.



32. What does the word 'wily' mean?
- (A) spiteful
 - (B) cunning
 - (C) defeated
 - (D) frightened
33. Which word best describes Sinon's feelings about his task?
- (A) despairing (B) resentful (C) impatient (D) anxious
34. Who asked the question, 'Were they really free at last?'
- (A) Sinon
 - (B) the Trojans
 - (C) the Greek army
 - (D) Sinon's fellow soldiers
35. The Trojans were ready to believe Sinon's story because
- (A) they were tired of battling the Greeks.
 - (B) they knew that the Greeks had left Troy.
 - (C) their gods had told them that they would win.
 - (D) they were looking for an excuse to celebrate.
36. Which piece of information is missing from the text?
- (A) which side won the war
 - (B) where Sinon was waiting outside Troy
 - (C) why Sinon was chosen to perform the task
 - (D) how the wooden horse was taken inside the city of Troy
37. Which of the following could replace the word 'beguiling', as it used in the text?
- (A) attractive
 - (B) deceptive
 - (C) enormous
 - (D) threatening
38. Which of the following sayings is **NOT** a lesson that can be drawn from the text?
- (A) Always question flattery.
 - (B) Only celebrate a real victory.
 - (C) The prize always goes to the strongest.
 - (D) Some things are just too good to be true.

Sweet recipes for life



Rated: PG

Starring: Emma McKellar, Paula Knox, Gabriel Eliason

Based on the novel *My sweet life* by Margot Riviere, this film has all the ingredients for a popular family movie: ambitious young girl, ruthless competition and tasty cooking.

Young and old alike will enjoy this inspiring story about the young life of Simone Miller (played by Emma McKellar) and her passion to become a pastry chef. Now a world-renowned pastry chef, Simone thinks back to her childhood when she is interviewed by a feisty reporter (Paula Knox).

The time shifts are easy to follow as the movie switches between Simone's early years and the present time in the restaurant where the interview occurs. Each shift in time is cleverly matched to follow the sequence of the meal taking place during the interview. During the entrée the reporter asks Simone the predictable question: 'What were the major influences on your decision to become a pastry chef?' Simone's reply is anything but predictable as she reveals her past.

The first flashback shows how Simone's tastebuds are awakened when she eats at the home of her wealthy school friend, Max (Jack White), and his father, French restaurateur Bruno (Gabriel Eliason). She is entranced by a dessert made by Bruno called croquembouche ('crisp in the mouth'), made from custard-filled cream puffs piled high and covered with spun sugar. When she returns home to her mother's (Ellen Bas) indifference to food, the tension between mother and daughter is evident. What follows is Simone's quest to create the perfect dessert and find a way to add beauty



to her life. It's a journey which entails making custard hundreds of times. As Bruno says, 'Ze difference between try and triumph is a leetle umph!', while Simone's mother just says 'Umph!'

During the main course we find out life's not all plain sailing. As Simone warms to her interviewer, she sheds light on her attempts to get into Junior Top Chef. Things come unstuck in a hilarious scene with her archenemy Sue-Ann (Devina Shaw) which involves lashings of cream, egg whites and sticky sugar. As dessert is served, the camera lingers lovingly over the dishes created by the young Simone: fondants, éclairs and tartlets. You can almost taste the chocolate and smell the strawberries.

Though only 13, Emma McKellar's performance is an intelligent interpretation of the young Simone, and Jack White as Max is equally believable. The adult voice-over by Angelina Johns is charming and convincing. Some of the minor characters are a little lame compared to the strength of Simone's character, but fortunately their appearances are fleeting.

For a low-budget film, *Sweet recipes for life* is a treat—delicious but not sickly sweet. Despite following a tried-and-true formula—passion and persistence pay off—the film never becomes corny.

39. Who inspired Simone to become a pastry chef?
- (A) Max
 - (B) Bruno
 - (C) Sue-Ann
 - (D) her mother
40. According to the text, the time shifts in the movie are matched by
- (A) the unpredictability of Simone's replies.
 - (B) the type of food that Simone learns to prepare.
 - (C) the order of the meal being served during the interview.
 - (D) the increasing closeness between Simone and her interviewer.
41. What do the words 'crisp in the mouth' explain?
- (A) a slang word
 - (B) a poetic word
 - (C) a foreign term
 - (D) a scientific term
42. 'Bruno says: "Ze difference between try and triumph is a leetle umph!"'
What do we know about Bruno from this quotation?
- (A) He likes to boast.
 - (B) He never went to school.
 - (C) He is a difficult character.
 - (D) He has a sense of humour.
43. Which of the following words is used as a verb in the fifth paragraph?
- (A) 'sailing'
 - (B) 'attempts'
 - (C) 'lashings'
 - (D) 'taste'
44. In the quotation '*Sweet recipes for life* is a treat', the word 'treat' is an example of
- (A) a pun.
 - (B) a simile.
 - (C) alliteration.
 - (D) personification.
45. Which feature of the movie particularly impressed the reviewer?
- (A) the witty dialogue
 - (B) the choice of setting
 - (C) the originality of the plot
 - (D) the casting of the main characters



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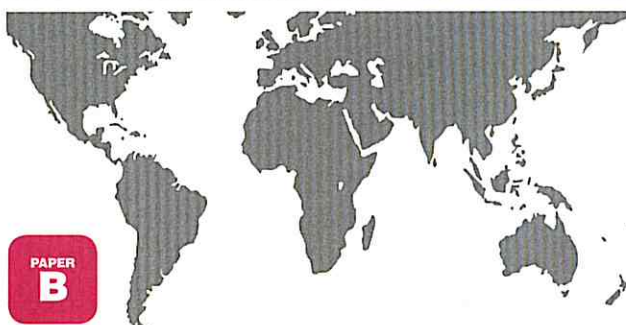


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Australia	Year 4
Brunei	Primary 4
Indonesia	Year 5
Malaysia	Standard 4
New Zealand	Year 5
Pacific	Year 4
Singapore	Primary 3
South Africa	Grade 4



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